

SPECIAL ELECTION ISSUE
HEAR FROM THE CANDIDATES

ENCINO ENTERPRISE

Volume 7, Issue 153 | A Compendious Source of Information | October 15,2026

NEWS IN BRIEF

34th Annual Sherman Oaks Street Fair to Be Held This Sunday on Ventura Blvd.

The 34th annual Sherman Oaks Street Fair returns this Sunday, October 18, from 10 am to 6 pm on Ventura Blvd., from Kester Ave. to Van Nuys Blvd. This is the largest single-day event in the Valley, with up to 100,000 attendees. There will be two entertainment stages, a cocktail lounge, a carnival, food trucks, artists, a pet zone, local business booths and more. For details, visit shermanoaksstreetfair.org.

Need Clarification on the 2026 Propositions? Join the EPOA for an Interactive Discussion

The Encino Property Owner's Association will host a Zoom on Tuesday, October 20, at 7 pm with an interactive discussion of California Propositions on the General Election ballot. An easy to understand explanation of the Propositions along with pro and con arguments will be provided by a panel of distinguished public affairs consultants including Josh Englander and Yusef Robb. Don't rely on the spin of TV commercials and mail. This is a great opportunity to hear unbiased and simplified information to become better informed before you vote. To request the Zoom link, email info@encinopoa.com.

Jesse Gabriel Garners $22 Million to Clean Up Sepulveda Basin

California Assemblymember and Assembly Budget Chair Jesse Gabriel was instrumental in garnering a $22 million state budget appropriate to support community improvements in the Sepulveda Basin. This transformative funding will support park accessibility, fire prevention and extreme heat mitigation, and public safety improvements. The Sepulveda Basin is over 2,000 acres and is the largest public open space in the San Fernando Valley. Gabriel will officially present a check to L.A. Mayor Karen Bass in the near future. Gabriel represents Assembly District 46, which covers from West Hills to Van Nuys.

Voters Urged to Walk Ballots Into Post Office or Use Local Ballot Boxes

This election, voters are urged to walk their ballots into the post office, or use one of the many ballot boxes around the valley.

Fears of late postmarks from reduced postal services, plus increasing mail theft, are fostering the suggestions.

On their end the USPS plans to take other "extraordinary measures" for mail-in ballots. Starting October 24, 10 days before Election Day on November 3, some post offices may extend their opening and closing times by a half-hour and set up lines or drive-through lanes just for voters who want to get a manual postmark for their mail-in ballot.

And starting October 26, USPS says it plans to speed up delivery of ballots.

Official ballot drop boxes have arrived and are a safe, accessible means to cast your vote. Boxes are located throughout the city and will close at 8 pm on Election Day.

Place your voted ballot card inside the return envelope, seal the envelope, sign and date it and drop it in the box! The boxes are bolted in place, or otherwise secured, and the ballots are picked up by teams of two people so there is no question about one person hiding ballots.

Or you could vote early at a designated early voting location. You still get to vote in person, but with the number of people at the location spread out over a few days. If you love voting in person, but don't want the line on election day, this might be an option for you.

You can even keep track of your vote with a unique code that is printed on your ballot. Tracking your vote-by-mail ballot—when it is mailed, received, and counted—has never been easier.



The California Secretary of State offers "Where's My Ballot?"- a way for voters to track and receive notifications on the status of their vote-by-mail ballot. Powered by BallotTrax, "Where's My Ballot?" lets voters know where their ballot is, and its status, every step of the way.

Sign-up at WheresMyBallot.sos.ca.gov to receive automatic email, SMS (text), or voice call notifications about your ballot.

Encino ballot box locations include:

-Encino-Tarzana Branch Library (18231 Ventura Blvd., Tarzana)

-Encino Community Center (16953 Ventura Blvd., Encino)

-Balboa Sports Center (17015 Burbank Blvd., Encino)

-Reseda Recreation Center (18411 Victory Blvd., Reseda)

-Tarzana Recreation Center (5655 Vanalden Ave., Tarzana)

Whichever option works best for you, whichever you choose, just ensure you exercise your right to vote!

CALENDAR





Community Calendar

* The Encino Neighborhood Council will hold their general board meeting on Wednesday, October 28, at 7 pm. For meeting details and agenda, visit encinonc.org.

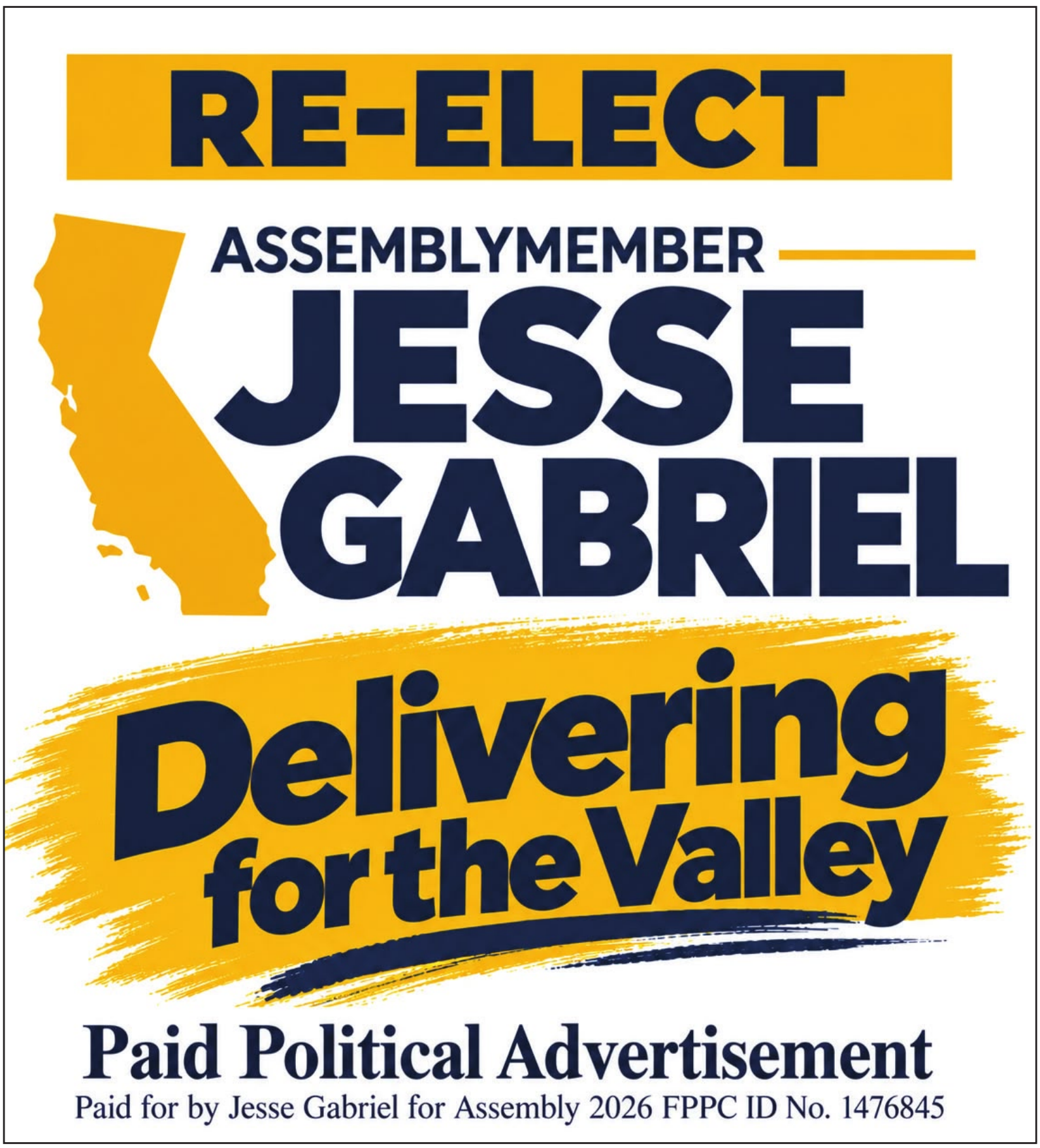
* The San Fernando Valley Multiple Myeloma Support Group was started in June 2012 by Malcolm Katz and now boasts over 200 patients and caregivers. The group will meet by Zoom or in-person at 7 pm on Wednesday, October 21. Katz secures well-recognized, knowledgeable and experienced medical professionals to speak at group meetings. If you have been diagnosed with multiple myeloma, or care for someone who has been diagnosed with multiple myeloma, please contact Katz by phone at (818) 515-6060 or by email at sfvmmgroup@gmail.com for more information on this free meeting.

* The Southern California Garden Club will continue their 100th anniversary season with a meeting on Tuesday, October 20, featuring a program, "Catalina: Like Nowhere Else on Earth," at 11 am presented by Lexy Coons and Gina Nelson. They will explore what makes Catalina Island one of California's most extraordinary places, from its iconic landscapes and rare endemic plants and animals to ongoing efforts to protect and restore this treasured ecosystem. The free meeting kicks off at 9:30 am at the Sepulveda Garden Center (16633 Magnolia Blvd.) with a plant market, specimen display and more.

* The Sherman Oaks Encino Chamber of Commerce will hold their next "Mix & Mingle" networking event on Tuesday, October 27, from 5:30 to 7 pm. For details and to register, visit shermanoaksencinochamber.org.

* Celebrate Halloween with the West Valley Regional Library on Thursday, October 29, from 4 to 6 pm. Come in costumes (appropriate for a library environment) and enjoy their spooktacular activities and programs, including spooky stories, crafts, games, and a costume parade. Their theme is the Addams Family! This program is intended for children and teens.

* Our Lady of Grace school will hold their Fall Family Festival on Saturday, October 17, from 5 to 10 pm at 5011 White Oak Ave. There will be food, music, games and more. All proceeds benefit the church and the school. For more info, see olgfamilyfestival.com.



People in the News



Ten young finalists took the stage at the Black Box Theatre in Reseda for the finale of Voice of the Valley, a community singing competition organized by Glowing Note Foundation, a Reseda-based nonprofit dedicated to bringing music and opportunities into children's lives.

Every finalist received a musical instrument to take home, presented by Tim Gaspar, with special guest Bobby Parks joining the celebration. Along with trophies, certificates, and gift cards, the children left with wonderful memories and an instrument to continue their musical journey.

"I really feel our San Fernando Valley needed something like this," said Glowing Note Foundation founder Noor Rimburg.

For more information on the foundation and its events, visit glowingnote.org.

Marietta Gevorgian, 16, from Burbank, (third from left) was crowned the winner of Voice of the Valley 2026 on October 4, with Syra Merchant named First Runner-Up and Siena Seven Siderman Second Runner-Up.

The theatre was packed with families, friends, and supporters cheering on the young performers. But perhaps the most beautiful part of the evening was what happened around the music - families from different backgrounds and cultures coming together to celebrate.



Lagerlof, LLP's Partner **Dena Klotz** has been selected as a nominee for the LA Times Studios Inspirational Women Forum & Leadership Awards. Now in its sixth year, the Inspirational Women Forum & Leadership Awards recognizes female business leaders who have achieved remarkable success and made significant contributions to their organizations and industries.

Klotz is a Partner and the Managing Attorney of Lagerlof, LLP's Encino office. Her practice focuses on estate and gift tax planning, estate planning, business succession planning, charitable giving, trusts, wills, powers of attorney, post-death administration, and probate. She also holds a master's degree in Marriage and Family Therapy and previously practiced as a therapist specializing in resolving conflicts with couples and families.

COMMUNITY

English Channel



By Rodger Sterling

English Channel offers the best of the late editor Rodger Sterling's columns that ran continuously in the local papers since 1968.

• Ponder this: A person with a basement full of vodka: alcoholic. A person with a basement full of wine: classy.

• Marriage is like a deck of cards. In the beginning all you need is two hearts and a diamond. By the end, you wish you had a club and a spade.

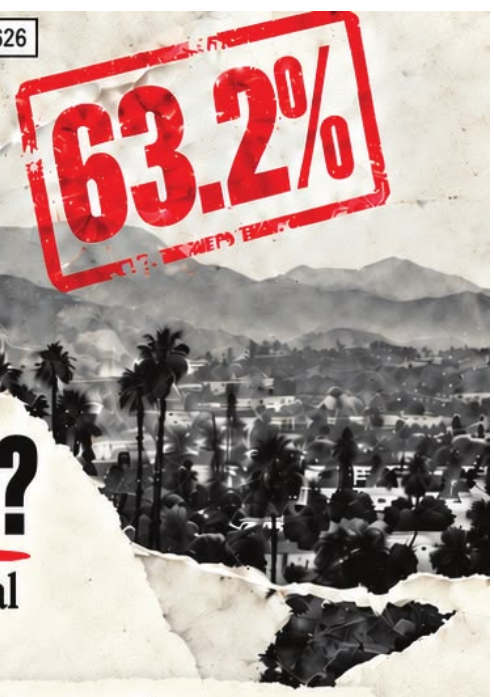
• Don Sanelli reports the man who wrote the "Hokey Pokey" died at the age of 93. The most traumatic part for his family was getting him in the coffin. They put his left leg in. And then the trouble started.

• I'm declaring myself officially middle-aged. I don't need drugs anymore, thank God. I can get the same effect by just standing up real fast.

• Oscar Wilde said, "Bigamy is having one wife too many. Monogamy is the same."

PAID FOR BY LARRY THOMPSON FOR CONGRESS, ID# C00907626

Why Did 63.2% of Brad Sherman's Constituents Vote To Remove Him From Office?



Read their comments below, posted on his official social media pages.

A SELECTION OF COMMENTS

"'Please retire. You're not representing the interests of your constituents."
— Kayte Everything-ForEveryone, Facebook, August 31, 2026

"WHAT HAVE YOU DONE FOR US? 30 YEARS IS TOO LONG IN THE SAME SEAT!!!"
— Eileen Conn, Facebook, August 24, 2026

"As one of your constituents I want you to concern yourself with OUR district in the San Fernando Valley, CALIFORNIA!!!"
— Chris Hovsepian-Thie, Facebook, August 16, 2026

"You lost my vote."
— Edward J Jones, Facebook, September 3, 2026

"'Time to vote Sherman out of office."
— Reza R Rahaman, Facebook, July 22, 2026

"I can't believe you're a congressman."
— Erica Lee, Facebook, August 28, 2026

"Our Representative Sherman is a disgrace."
— Dave Waterbury, X, October 27, 2017

"Can't wait for when we vote you OUT!!"
— Sumaya Bezrati, Facebook, September 3, 2026

"I will NEVER vote for you again."
— Ken Kamlet, Facebook, August 16, 2026

VOTE FOR LARRY THOMPSON
FOR CONGRESS
LarryThompsonForCongress.com
SCAN TO LEARN MORE

LOCAL NEWS

Valley News Group
Warner Center News | Valley Vantage
Las Virgenes And Calabasas Enterprise | North Valley News | Encino Enterprise

PUBLISHER
Kathleen Sterling
EDITOR
Katie Sterling
EXECUTIVE ASSISTANT
Connie Hein
BUSINESS EDITOR
Miri Rossitto
HEALTH EDITOR
Allie Priore
EDITORIAL ADVISORY BOARD
Joyce Fletcher
Martin Cooper
Rickey Gelb
Brad Rosenheim
Miri Rossitto
Richard Sherman
Scott Silverstein
Molly Unger
John Walker
Diana Williams
Dennis Zine

Valley Vantage, Warner Center News, Las Virgenes Enterprise and Encino Enterprise are published weekly by Kathleen Sterling. Offices are located at 22025 Ventura Blvd. #303, Woodland Hills CA 91364. Phone 818.313.9545 / Fax 818.302.1417. Email valleynewsgroup@gmail.com. Website: www.valleynewsgroup.com. Opinions expressed in articles are those belonging to the article's author and do not necessarily reflect the view of the Publisher or its advertisers. Submissions are welcome and must include name, address and phone. All submissions become the property of the Publisher. Valley Vantage is a legally adjudicated newspaper of general circulation serving the County of Los Angeles by Superior Court Degree No. SFC 858.

PHONE 818.313.9545 FAX 818.302.1417
Email: EncinoEnterprise@gmail.com
22025 Ventura Blvd. #303 Woodland Hills CA 91364
www.valleynewsgroup.com
Facebook.com/valleynewsgroupwoodlandhills

valleynewsgroup.com @valleynewsgroup

@valleynewsgroupwoodlandhills

REGISTER FOR A FREE DIGITAL SUBSCRIPTION!
Get the Paper Deliverd Directly to Your Inbox Bi-Monthly
Email us at EncinoEnterprise@gmail.com
and say
"Register Me"

Word on the Street



By Kathleen Sterling

Full disclosure.

I haven't endorsed a candidate in over 30 years. There are a lot of reasons. The main one, however, is that I really try to be fair to all.

Throwing your hat in the political ring is gutsy, brave and all-consuming. I admire the candidates. I applaud their efforts and I want to support them.

So in this issue we asked every candidate running for a local office to submit an ad and editorial. They could spend as little as $100 or as much as a full page. I would give them the same editorial space regardless. We posed some tough questions, germaine to each office.

Instead of endorsing any one candidate, I ask you, the reader, to look at these pages and see who decided the valley voters were worth talking to.

There are candidates running that I have asked repeatedly to submit op-eds. To write about topics that are relevant to the west valley.

Many said yes. Some said no. Some ignored it.

I trust my readers to be intelligent human beings who can read between the lines.

Who has stepped up to the plate?

Who has been visible in the community?

Who has taken a stand on the issues?

Who has had the balls to answer the questions we threw at them?

Look at these pages and make an informed decision. The one thing I ask of all of you is to just get out and vote. I hear so many complaints about the city, the council, crime, homeless, traffic. You have one chance to make a difference - and that is your vote.

Choose the candidate you think will best represent you - and your interests - and vote for them. We're trying to make it easy, with a list of places to drop your ballot. With the website to track your vote.

Again, I wanted to applaud those candidates who are running here in the paper. Years ago they asked me to run for City Council and not only did I say no, but "hell no!" and ran the other direction. My father in law was both editor of the local paper and the mayor of the town. He used to say as mayor he needed six votes, as publisher - just one to say what he wanted.

I like my platform. I like being able to say what I want. I've been at this gig 45 years in March, and pretty much have seen it all and written it all. People have loved the paper, hated the paper, loved the editorials, hated the editorials.

But one thing holds true.

They read us.

Whether they agree or disagree with my diatribes, they keep reading. Because we're the local paper for this community, and we'll continue to bring you the news, whether you agree with it or not.



We Ask the Candidates:



Karen Bass
Candidate for Mayor, City of Los Angeles

Q: What's going to happen with the homeless if they aren't off the street in larger numbers by the Olympics?

A: No one in Los Angeles should have to live on the street, and no neighborhood should have to live with encampments. If re-elected, I will build a homelessness system the city controls, one that gets people indoors, treats their health needs, and helps them rebuild lives of independence.

We know what works. And we plan to scale these efforts before the Olympics:

End Major Encampments Across the City: We will resolve every major encampment in LA by moving people into shelter and services and keeping those areas from becoming encampments again.

Get People Into Housing Faster — and Keep Them There: We will expand interim housing using underutilized public land and public-private partnerships, speed the move into permanent housing, and help more people stay housed instead of cycling back onto the street.

Fix State Law So People Can Get the Mental Health Treatment They Need: We will work with the state to change the law so the city has better tools to connect people to mental health treatment, even when they're too sick to seek it themselves.

Put the City in Charge of Its Own Homelessness System: We will centralize authority over homelessness programs under the city so its leaders are accountable for results, and make sure housing built with our tax dollars serves Angelenos first.

Build Real Pathways to Self-Sufficiency, Not Just a Bed for the Night: We will expand health care, life skills, and job training programs at interim housing sites and build a culture of personal accountability so temporary help leads to lasting independence.

Bring Healthcare to People, Instead of Expecting Them to Find It: We will bring Medi-Cal covered care directly to interim housing sites, including through university clinical rotation programs that put supervised health care students where people live.

Reach Specific Groups With Tailored Solutions: We will build targeted strategies for populations with distinct needs, including transition-age youth, veterans, and domestic violence survivors.

Expand Homelessness Prevention Programs: We will work with state legislators to expand rental subsidies for vulnerable residents and use ULA and Measure A funds to give tenants flexible emergency help before they lose their homes.

Q: People are up in arms because of their recent grossly inflated DWP bills, often higher than their mortgage payments every month. At the same time the city is forcing contractors to go all electric. Isn't this a reverse incentive?

A: I've heard the concerns about spikes in DWP bills, and I'm pushing DWP to do everything possible to avoid these price increases and help homeowners, renters, and business owners save money.

I also urge Angelenos to take advantage of DWP's many programs that help customers reduce their power usage and save money – from rebates for energy-efficient appliances to free home energy improvements.

Energy requirements for new homes are set by statewide building energy codes, but there are cost-effective ways to meet them, like installing heat pumps or solar panels paired with battery storage. DWP also offers financial incentives for all-electric homes.

Transform Your
Business

Our Expertise is Your Secret Weapon

Whether you're looking to boost brand awareness, dominate digital spaces, or engage audiences in ways that matter, we challenge the status quo and deliver results that last.

+ BUSINESS MARKETING & STRATEGY
+ BRANDING & REBRANDING
+ PUBLICITY & PUBLIC RELATIONS
+ SOCIAL MEDIA MARKETING
+ WEBSITE DEVELOPMENT & MANAGEMENT
+ GRAPHIC DESIGN
+ PHOTOGRAPHY & VIDEOGRAPHY
+ COPYWRITING
+ NONPROFIT DEVELOPMENT

COWE COMMUNICATIONS
BUSINESS & BRAND DEVELOPMENT

COWE.COM | 800-527-3646

PAID POLITICAL ADVERTISEMENT

MAYOR KAREN BASS IS DELIVERING FOR THE VALLEY

- Surging law enforcement and **public safety support** to address burglaries and break-ins in the Valley.
- Fast tracking **housing Angelenos can afford** to reduce rent and protect single family neighborhoods.
- **Secured funding and expedited wildfire prevention** and clearing of brush along the Sepulveda Basin.
- Enacted the **first Film Tax Credit and reduced filming costs** to keep Hollywood production jobs in LA.
- Expanding funding, contracting, and procurement **opportunities for small businesses.**



Meanwhile, No-Show Nithya Raman doesn't do her job on the city council. She won't show up as mayor.

VOTE MAYOR KAREN BASS BY NOVEMBER 3
RETURN YOUR BALLOT TODAY.

Paid for by Re-Elect Karen Bass for Mayor 2026 - General (FPPC ID #1492037), 445 S. Figueroa St., Ste. 2400 Los Angeles, CA 90071. Funding details at ethics.lacity.gov.



BUSINESS

We Ask the Candidates:



Larry Thompson
Candidate for United States Congress

Q: The federal government gave a lot of money to California for homeless initiatives – and at one point took back $150 million that wasn't implemented. Would you vote again for federal funding of homeless services in L.A.?

A: Yes, I would vote for federal funding of homeless services in Los Angeles, with strict accountability. We have a moral responsibility to help people get off the streets and restore safe public spaces. Funding should support effective housing, mental health care, addiction treatment, and services that help people regain stability. It should come with independent audits, public reporting, firm deadlines, and measurable results. If an agency cannot put the money to work effectively, those funds should be redirected to providers that can. To that end, I would seek substantially greater participation from churches, synagogues, and other religious and community organizations. These groups can bring compassion, local relationships, volunteers, and experience serving people in need. I would call this partnership "Good Sam"—a Good Samaritan effort bringing government and community organizations together to help people achieve lasting stability. Participating providers would be held to the same accountability standards and expected to serve people regardless of their faith. Success must be measured by people helped into stable housing—not simply by dollars spent.

Q: If you win but Democrats win the House, how would you make a difference as a freshman member of the minority party?

A: I would make a difference by doing what I have done throughout my career as a lawyer, film producer, and talent manager: bring people together, negotiate, and deliver results. As a freshman Republican in a Democratic-controlled House, I would seek partners in both parties on practical priorities: affordability, wildfire recovery and prevention, homelessness, public safety, and bringing film and television jobs back to California. I would also build responsive district offices to help constituents navigate federal agencies, resolve problems with veterans' benefits, Social Security, and Medicare, and pursue federal resources for our communities. Being in the minority would limit my ability to set the House agenda. It would not limit my responsibility to work hard, build relationships, and represent every constituent. My party does not decide my conscience. My job would be to put people over politics.



Tracey Schroeder
Candidate for CA State Assembly

Q: Homeowners are fighting Assembly Bill 2011, which approves higher density in residential neighborhoods. Do you support putting apartment complexes in the middle of residential neighborhoods?

A: I am OPPOSED to the unconscionable manner in which this bill became California law, removing the voice of local residents and city leaders. Sewer lines, water pressure, electricity grids, parking spaces, grocery store access and fire-escape routing have been neglected in Woodland Hills, West Hills, Encino, Tarzana, Reseda, Canoga Park, Van Nuys and throughout our state.

Community voiced/voted specific infrastructure guidelines are needed to override some of the generic defaults our state legislators dumped on the people. Some local roads were more accessible until recently; but are now squeezed-in and deemed undriveable by fire-trucks. This too must be addressed before density-housing is allowed to pour in and flood the zones. AB 2011 must be amended. We can work together and do better. Tell your friends to VOTE: Tracey Schroeder for CA State Assembly District 46.

Q: There's a provision in the "Billionaires Tax" that they can reduce the threshold to any level at will – so an average person can have their assets taxed. Do you support this provision that's in the fine print?

A: HECK NO! I believe in reducing taxes and red tape so we can make life more affordable for people. The "bait and switch" loophole in the "Billionaire tax" on the ballot would open a "Pandora's Box" allowing astronomical tax increases on regular people, too. Vote NO. CA's spending is nearly double what it was less than 10 years ago and we continue PAYING BILLIONS in taxes-for highly questionable notions including a non-existent train. NEW taxes are starting soon on our phones, computers, apps... gas... miles we drive... yet we are no better off. Let's return to common sense. I'm running to help fix our school system and working to do it on a reduced state budget. California should be safe and affordable. Vote Tracey Schroeder for CA State Assembly 46 by November 3rd, 2026.

JOB LISTINGS:

Edge Americas Sports Inc. seeks Head Coach in Los Angeles, CA. Develop and oversee soccer coaching programs, training sessions, athlete development strategies, performance analysis, and daily coaching operations. Occasional domestic travel required. Requires Bachelor's in Sports and Exercise Science, Kinesiology, Physical Education, or related field, plus 24 months of experience as Soccer Coach. Salary: $36,000/year. Send resume to Edge Americas Sports Inc., Attn: Carlo Peyron, 10801 National Blvd, Suite 605, Los Angeles, CA 90064

Vice President, Investments (CIM Group, LP – Los Angeles, CA). Duties: Sourcing and executing transactions meeting investment criteria of CIM's Infrastructure and Impact investment vehicles. Lead transactions from sourcing through disposition: investment sourcing, underwriting, transaction negotiation, coordination of diligence, and execution, asset management and oversight of business plan. 5-10% North American travel. Required: BS in Economics, Finance, International Economics and Finance, or related. 7 years' experience: investment banking or private equity, including infrastructure investing; business and investments; financial modeling (debt and project finance modeling). 5 years' experience with: written communication and presentations in the banking or private equity sector; management of multiple stakeholders and deadlines. Send resume (referencing "Vice President, Investments"): Andrew Nguyen at anguyen@cimgroup.com or 4700 Wilshire Blvd., Los Angeles, CA 90010. Rate of Pay: $250,00/year.





Jesse Gabriel
Candidate for CA State Assembly

Declined to submit anwers.

Which Exercise is Ideal for Brain Health?

Scientists have long stressed that physical exercise is not only beneficial for your body, but can have great benefits for one's mental health as well. Research is now showing that different types of exercise may trigger different biological pathways in your brain.



In a recent review from *Frontiers in Sports and Active Living*, researchers centered their studies on the importance of two molecules: BDNF, which supports neuronal health, learning and memory, and IGF-1, which is tied to brain maintenance and repair.

The study found that aerobic or cardio exercise had the strongest connection to BDNF or brain-derived neurotrophic factor. Partaking in approximately 65% or more of maximum effort cardio, two to three times weekly for at least 40 minutes is a strong brain stimulus.

On the flip side, resistance training was shown to influence IGF-1 or Insulin-like Growth Factor 1. Frequency of weight training rather than intensity was key for this molecule. Incorporating a few days of weight training with cardio mixed in a weekly workout program, allows the brain to target both BDNF and IGF-1.

Physical movement increases blood flow and oxygen to the brain, stimulates the growth of new neurons, and enlarges the memory-critical hippocampus.

While there is no specific workout plan to prevent cognitive decline, scientists are stating that a combination of weight training plus cardio can be an ideal mix to keep your body and your mind sharp.

Your Future, Your Plan.

For a limited time, save $2,000 on our all-inclusive egg freezing Nest Package. **Offer available September 15th through December 15th.**

*Restrictions Apply

HRCFertility
Bringing Dreams to Life





HEALTH

Dignity Health Sounds The Alarm On The Most Common Medical Emergency You Haven't Prepared For

Sudden cardiac arrest claims hundreds of thousands of lives in the U.S. each year. Globally, cardiac arrest is responsible for more deaths than colorectal cancer, breast cancer, prostate cancer, influenza, pneumonia, auto accidents, HIV, firearms and house fires combined.

As Dignity Health Northridge Hospital Medical Center recognizes National Sudden Cardiac Arrest (SCA) Awareness Month this October and World Restart a Heart Day on October 16, Dignity Health is encouraging community members to know their heart health, recognize the signs of cardiac arrest and, most importantly, know what to do when every second counts. Immediate action by a bystander, including cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR) and use of an automated external defibrillator (AED), can significantly improve a person's chance of survival.

Sudden cardiac arrest occurs when the heart's electrical system malfunctions, causing the heart to stop beating effectively. It's different from a heart attack, which occurs when blood flow to the heart is blocked. A heart attack can lead to cardiac arrest, but they are not the same condition. Cardiac arrest can happen suddenly and without warning. The key signs are:

-Sudden collapse or loss of responsiveness

-No normal breathing or only gasping or abnormal breathing

-No response when the person is spoken to or tapped

If someone is unresponsive and not breathing normally, bystanders should assume the person is experiencing cardiac arrest and act immediately.

If you witness someone suddenly collapse:

-Call 911 immediately and follow the dispatcher's instructions.

-Push. Start hands-only CPR by pushing hard and fast in the center of the chest.

-Shock. Get an AED and follow its voice and visual instructions. The device will determine if a shock is needed.

Knowing what to do before an emergency happens can make it easier to respond with confidence. Dignity Health encourages residents to consider taking a CPR course, learning where AEDs are located in the places they regularly visit and talking with family members about what to do if someone experiences cardiac arrest.

While sudden cardiac arrest can occur unexpectedly, some cases are associated with underlying conditions. Knowing your personal risk factors and discussing concerns with a health care provider can help identify potential heart problems.

Dignity Health recommends that community members:

-Know your numbers: Talk with your health care provider about blood pressure, cholesterol and blood sugar, which can provide important information about your cardiovascular health.

-Pay attention to symptoms: Unexplained fainting, particularly during exercise, heart palpitations, chest discomfort or shortness of breath should be discussed with a health care provider.

-Know your family history: A family history of sudden cardiac death or certain inherited heart conditions may warrant further discussion with a health care provider.

-Practice heart-healthy habits: Regular physical activity, a balanced diet and avoiding tobacco can support cardiovascular health.

To learn more about heart health and ways to reduce your risk of heart disease, visitcommonspirit.org/services-specialties/heart-care.





After Breast Cancer, Reconstruction Is No Longer One-Size-Fits-All

By Andrew T. Cohen, MD, FACS

For women facing breast cancer, a mastectomy can affect much more than physical appearance. For some patients, losing one or both breasts can become an emotional part of an already difficult cancer journey. What I want women to know during Breast Cancer Awareness Month is that reconstruction has changed tremendously, and today there are more choices available than many patients realize.

Modern breast reconstruction is no longer a one-size-fits-all operation. Depending on a woman's cancer treatment, anatomy, health, lifestyle, and personal preferences, reconstruction can be performed at the time of mastectomy or months, and sometimes years, later.

Implant-based reconstruction remains an important option and may involve a tissue expander followed by an implant or, in appropriately selected patients, an implant placed at the time of mastectomy. Advances in surgical planning have also allowed some women to undergo skin-sparing or nipple-sparing mastectomy, preserving more of the natural breast envelope when it is oncologically appropriate.

For other patients, reconstruction using their own tissue may be considered. Procedures such as DIEP flap reconstruction use skin and fat from the abdomen to recreate the breast while preserving the abdominal muscle.

Fat grafting has also become an extremely valuable tool in reconstruction. Fat can be collected through liposuction from another area of the body and carefully transferred to the breast to improve contour, soften irregularities, and help create better symmetry.



Dr. Andrew Cohen

Just as importantly, reconstruction is a choice, not an obligation. Some women decide against breast reconstruction and choose an aesthetic flat closure. There is no single "correct" decision.

To me, one of the greatest advancements in breast reconstruction is not simply a new implant or surgical technique. It is our ability to offer women more individualized options.

Cancer treatment can make patients feel as though many decisions are suddenly being made for them. Reconstruction gives us an opportunity to return some of that choice and control. The goal is not to create a "perfect" breast. It is to help each woman determine what feeling whole after breast cancer means to her.

Dr. Andrew Cohen is a Board-Certified Plastic Surgeon practicing in the heart of Encino. With more than 25 years of surgical experience in aesthetic and reconstructive procedures of the face, breast and body, Dr. Cohen has become a trusted name in plastic surgery and prides himself on offering his meticulous technique, natural results and a patient-centered approach.

What Is Lung Adenocarcinoma?

The Vatican recently shared the news this week that Pope Leo XIV underwent surgery after being diagnosed with lung adenocarcinoma.

Lung adenocarcinoma is the most common type of non-small cell lung cancer that accounts for approximately 40% of all lung cancer cases. It begins in the cells of the lung that make mucus, also known as the epithelial cells. Due to its slow nature of growth, lung adenocarcinoma is more likely to be found before it has spread.

While smoking is most attributed to the risk factors for lung adenocarcinoma, it is also the most common form of lung cancer in individuals who have never smoked. Traditionally, cases are more prevelant in women than men and is more likely to occur in younger people.

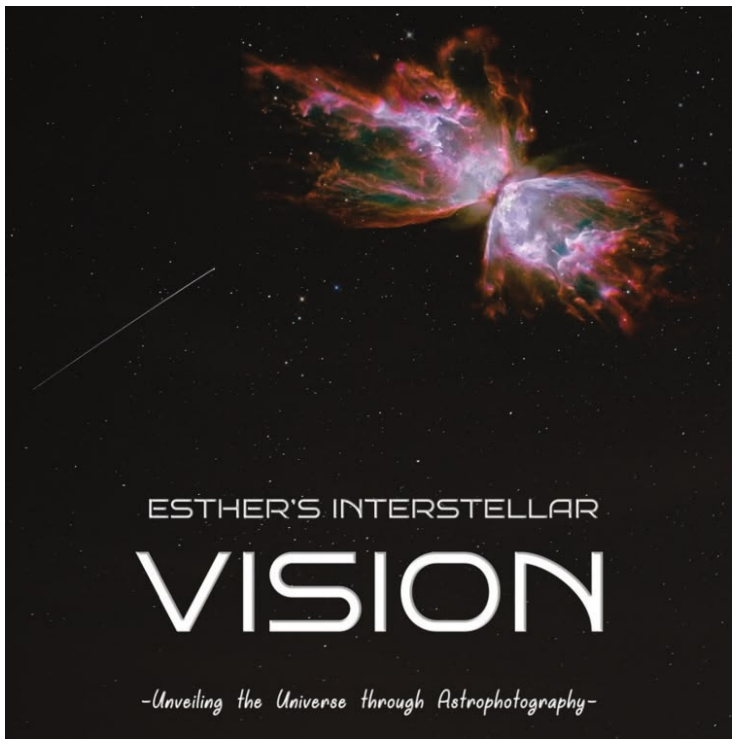
The cancer is diagnosed through imaging testing to screen for abnormal lung masses and can include CT scans, PET scans, a chest X-ray or MRI scan. Once identified, treatment can include chemotherapy, radiation, surgery or a combination of these options. Since many lung cancer patients don't have symptoms during the early stages, preventive screenings are key. If the cancer has not spread outside of the lungs, the five-year survival rate is approximately 67%.





ENTERTAINMENT





San Fernando Valley Filmmaker Brings Astronomy to the Screen

Esther Ancrum, a San Fernando Valley filmmaker and DGA director, recently completed their short film, *Esther's Interstellar Vision*, inspired by their passion for astronomy and astrophotography.

Esther's Interstellar Vision is an experimental narrative short that follows a young woman who escapes into the wilderness with her telescope. Through long nights under the stars, she captures celestial images and writes poetry, drawing inspiration from the quiet beauty of the cosmos. With a red light glowing to protect her night vision, she slowly assembles her gear, documents constellations, and reflects on love, loneliness, and belonging.

This deeply personal film is grounded in the realities of amateur astrophotography and invites viewers to rediscover their own sense of wonder. Blending real astronomical imagery with poetic narration, the film incorporates NASA's sonification of the Big Bang — "The Sound of the Big Bang," created by physicist John G. Cramer from data captured by NASA's WMAP (Wilkinson Microwave Anisotropy Probe) — offering audiences a quiet and transformative journey of discovery.

Esther Ancrum is a DGA director focused on faith-based and science fiction storytelling. She directed *Esther's Interstellar Vision*, a visually driven sci-fi short film inspired by her passion for astronomy and the deeper questions of existence. Her goal is to create films that inspire, challenge, and leave a lasting impact. She often draws inspiration from astrophotography and her personal experience exploring the night sky.

Ancrum has trained in Unreal Engine and LED wall technology through IATSE Local 695, giving her experience in virtual production and modern filmmaking tools. Before directing, she worked in the film industry as both a production assistant and a video assist technician, gaining hands-on experience across multiple sets and learning how productions come together from the ground up.

It is a story about love, light, and finding yourself in quiet moments.

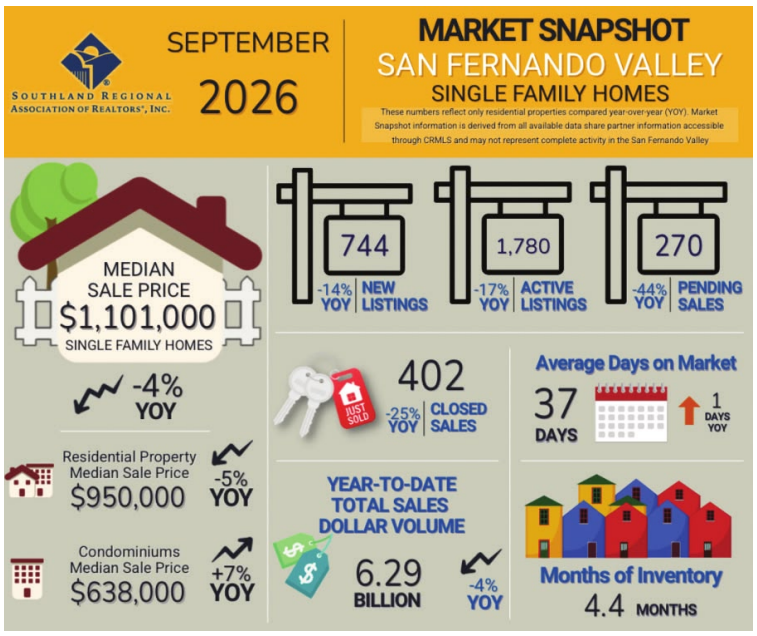
"Astrophotography has been my hobby for years. I've always had a deep love for astronomy, and that passion naturally evolved into photographing the stars. This film was inspired by my personal journey, as well as my father, who worked on Christopher Nolan's *Interstellar*. His work influenced my path as a filmmaker, and *Esther's Interstellar Vision* became a way to honor him. This project is not only a tribute to him, but also to my younger self, and to anyone who has ever felt drawn to the stars.

It is a story about love, light, and finding yourself in quiet moments. The red light used in the film reflects a real part of astrophotography, preserving night vision while working in the dark. Through the character Esther, who sets up her gear and reflects in solitude, I wanted to capture something honest and personal.

I made this film to show that your hobby, your solitude, your light, and your love matter, and can inspire others."

To learn more about the director and to watch the trailer for Esther's Interstellar Vision, visit estherfilmdirector.com





Valley Sales Tumbled and Inventory Tightened in Sept.

Closed escrows of homes and condominiums fell off a cliff during September in the San Fernando Valley, resale prices softened and inventories pulled back from record high territory, the Southland Regional Association of REALTORS® recently reported.

The Association reported 402 single-family home and 139 condominium closed escrows during September in the San Fernando Valley. The home tally was down 23.1% from a year ago and plummeted 14.8% from the 472 closings reported in August.

Similarly, the 139 condominium closings were down 20.1% from September 2025, and on a month-to-month basis the total was off 26.5% from the 189 closed escrows of July.

"Home sales follow familiar seasonal patterns," said Nicole Stinson, President of the 10,000-member Association serving the San Fernando and Santa Clarita valleys. "Closed escrows typically peak toward the end of summer then fall as days grow shorter and holidays approach. This year, with multiple uncertainties battering consumers – rising interest rates, inflation, tariffs, war – buyers and sellers pulled back sharper and faster."

After peaking at a record $1,188,000 in June, the median price of homes that changed owners dropped each month since. The September median price of $1,101,000 fell 4.3% from a year ago. The condominium median price bounced around since the record high of $655,000 was set in April, though each of the months was below the high point. The September condo median price of $638,000 was up 7.4% from a year ago.

"With the interest rate on home loans already over 7%, home sales increasingly may hinge on cash buyers and homeowners who must sell, regardless what's happening around them," said Valerie Biletsky, the Association's Chief Executive Officer. "No doubt there will be opportunities to buy in the months ahead, yet REALTORS® are hopeful inflation and the economy will calm and home loan interest rates will fall before the 2027 homebuying season kicks off next spring."

Active listings of single-family homes were setting records in 2025 and for the first two months of this year it looked like 2026 would see supply soar even higher.

Yet as economic uncertainties set in, new listings grew harder to find. The Association reported 1,780 active single-family home listings at the end of September. That was down 17.0% from a year ago, and 23.6% below the 2,331 active listings reported in June 2025, which was the high point since the Covic pandemic.

Similarly, condominium active listings in September came in at 841, down 20.9% from the 1,063 condo listings of September 2025. Condo listings have been above the 1,000-listing benchmark only three times since the pandemic – July, August and September of 2025.

SRAR's Income-to-Loan guide for September found that an income of $282,048 was needed to qualify for an 80% loan of $880,800 on a San Fernando Valley median-priced single-family home of $1,101,000. With the national average interest rate at 6.58% during September – compared to January 2022's 2.97% and below the 7.56% of December 2023 – the income needed to qualify fell 6.0% compared to a year ago. The monthly PITI — principal, interest, taxes and insurance payments — totaled $7,051.

SRAR local market statistics are compiled from all available data share partner information accessible through CRMLS and may not represent complete activity.

IS YOUR HOME SECURE?





In-house engineering AND construction!

- Deepened Foundation Systems
- Hillside Home Retrofitting
- Retaining Walls
- Deck Systems - Concrete & Wood

Lic. A-663409
ALPHA STRUCTURAL, INC.
GENERAL ENGINEERING CONTRACTORS
STRUCTURAL ENGINEERS

We have the experience necessary to complete any needed structural repair or upgrade in a cost-effective & timely manner.

Give us a call, we can help.

Structural repairs and upgrades on hillside homes
Alpha Structural, Inc. | (323) 522-4853 | www.alphastructural.com
© Alpha Structural, Inc. All Rights Reserved. 8334 Foothill Blvd., Sunland, CA 91040



Bell Canyon View Lot for Sale

Bell Canyon 1+ acre lot. Private graded driveway to huge flat pad.
Views and privacy in this gate guarded community.
Surrounded by mature oak trees. Completed survey, soil and ecological reports, landscape plan, and preliminary plan approval from Bell Canyon, streamlining the development process. All utilities are readily available in the street.
Minimal grading - you can be shovel-ready in 90 days. Las Virgenes School District.
Owner will carry 1st with 50% down. $735,910

Michael Maslen 818.216.1956
(DRE# 00523957) land1956@att.net

THE SORAYA

Fall Jazz

SAT OCT 3 8PM

Snarky Puppy
Somni
With Special Guest
Varijashree Venugopal

THU OCT 8 8PM

Branford Marsalis & Dianne Reeves
Celebrate John Coltrane
Featuring the Branford Marsalis Quartet

THU DEC 3 8PM

The Bad Plus
Farewell Tour
With Special Guests
Jeff Parker, Paul Bryan, and Scott Amendola

View the entire season and get your seats



Save More, **Join Membership!**

TheSoraya.org | (818) 677-3000 | @TheSorayaStage